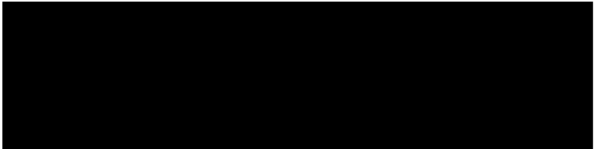

Department of the Air Force: Justification for Other Than Full and Open Competition

Dollar Value of this Acquisition: ☒ ≤ \$10M ☐ > \$10M and ≤ \$100M ☐ > \$100M and ≤ \$500M ☐ > \$500M

CERTIFICATIONS: CO certification serves as J&A approval ≤ \$10M, *See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory) at <https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory>* J&A Template Guidance tab

Date 30 April 2026	Contracting Officer (RFO 6.104-1(12)) Chris Stokes I certify that this justification is accurate and complete to the best of my knowledge and belief.	Signature 
Date 07 April 2026	Technical and Requirements Personnel (RFO 6.104(b)) Jacob M. Ramirez I certify that the supporting data herein, which is my responsibility, is accurate and complete.	Signature 

COORDINATION

APPROVALS (RFO 6.104-2(a) Table 6-1 & R-DFARS 206.104-72 Table 206.1)

See [J&A Template Guidance](https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory) (<https://usaf.dps.mil/sites/AFCC/AQCP/KnowledgeCenter/SitePages/DAF-Contracting-Compass/Part-6---Competition-Requirements.aspx#exceptions-to-full-and-open-competition-mandatory>) - Justification Approvals tab

NOTE 1: A signature block will appear here (replacing these notes) based on the "Dollar Value of this Acquisition" selected above. Since most digital signatures that include date/time-stamps are redacted before they are made publicly available, always insert the date in the "Date" cell when affixing a digital signature to this document.

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I. Agency and Contracting Activity (RFO 6.104-1(a)(1)):

AFRL/PZLEQ
WPAFB, OH 45433-5309

II. Nature and/or description of the action being approved (RFO 6.104-1(a)(2)):

The Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL/RWTE) at Eglin AFB is seeking comprehensive services for the calibration, maintenance, and repair of multiple presses, load frames, and a Triax system. The proposed period of performance will consist of a one-year base period with two, one-year option periods. All servicing must achieve ASTM accreditation to ensure the continuous and safe operation of the equipment, and the selected contractor shall be responsible for providing all parts, tools, supplies, equipment, and labor necessary to perform the required services.

1. The equipment to be calibrated and serviced includes:
 - a. Landmark Model 370.50 press - ASTM-accredited calibration and routine maintenance.
 - b. Criterion Model C43-504 presses - ASTM-accredited calibration and routine maintenance.
 - c. Landmark Model 311.41 press - Calibration and routine maintenance of the press system and associated HPU.
 - d. Exceed Model E42 load frame - Calibration and routine maintenance.
 - e. Triax system - Calibration of the load cells and overall system maintenance.
2. All services will be conducted on-site at Eglin AFB, FL, between 8:00 a.m. and 5:00 p.m., Monday through Friday, excluding federal holidays. Any work required outside of these established hours or at an off-site location must be mutually agreed upon in advance by the contractor and the government.
3. The resulting contract will include one primary service visit each year to calibrate all systems. It will also provide for one emergency repair visit and include a \$2,500 annual fund for repair parts.

III. Description of supplies/services required to meet agency needs (RFO 6.104-1(a)(3)):

AFRL/RWTE employs several systems for the production and physical characterization of energetic material samples. For sample production, the Landmark Model 370.50 press, Landmark Model 311.41 press, and Criterion Model C43-504 presses are utilized to create samples with precise tolerances. These presses require annual calibration and certification. For material characterization, the Exceed Model E42 load frame and Triax system are used to determine the compression and tension properties of the material, which requires periodic calibration to ensure data accuracy. MTS has been the service provider for all calibration, maintenance, and repair of this equipment since the time of purchase.

IV. Statutory Authority Permitting Other Than Full and Open Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(4)):

10 U.S.C. 3204(a)(1), Only one responsible source and no other supplies or services will satisfy agency requirements.

V. Rationale for Use of Authority (RFO 6.104-1(a)(5)):

MTS Systems Corporation is the only vendor with the proprietary parts, specialized labor, and critical incumbent

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experience necessary to calibrate and maintain the required presses, load frames, and Triax system (including Landmark Model 370.50, Criterion Model C-43-504, and Exceed Model E42) to acceptable standards. This conclusion is supported by extensive market research, including a Sources Sought notice and an Intent to Sole Source posting on SAM.gov, which confirmed a lack of available competition and demonstrated that no other vendors possess the capability to fulfill this mission-critical requirement without unacceptable risk or delay.

VI. Integrated Market Analysis and Efforts to Solicit Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(6), (8), and (10)):

In accordance with RFO Part 10, AFRL/RWTE and AFRL/PZLEQ conducted market research to determine whether contractors possess the expertise, capabilities, and experience to competently provide services to support the mission of AFRL/RWTE. This research included internet searches, engagement with industry representatives, and outreach to potential vendors capable of meeting the established criteria.

Initial market research was conducted by contacting the current contractor supporting the requirement: MTS Systems Corporation. In addition, an internet search was conducted using key words "Press/Load frame calibrations", "Landmark Model 370.50 calibration service" Criterion Model C-43-504 calibrations service, and "Exceed Model E42 calibrations". As a result, two companies were identified: Trescal, Inc. and Fox Valley Metrology, Ltd. Quotes/capability statements were requested from the three companies, and only MTS Systems Corporation responded.

Additionally, searches of GSA Advantage and other mandatory sources yielded no results matching the required specifications.

PZLEQ also posted a Sources Sought notice to SAM.gov inviting responses from capable companies, receiving two responses: BiomedRx Federal and Cenmed Enterprises Inc. Both companies work on medical lab equipment. After speaking with both vendors, it was determined neither company is capable of supplying the requirement.

VII. Determination of Fair and Reasonable Cost (RFO 6.104-1(a)(7)):

The Contracting Officer is responsible for evaluating, determining, and documenting the anticipated contract cost/price is fair and reasonable in accordance with RFO Subpart 15.4, Contract Pricing.

VIII. Any Other Facts Supporting the Justification (RFO 6.104-1(a)(9)):

Awarding a contract to any source other than MTS Systems Corporation would result in unacceptable risk and mission delays, causing direct harm to the government. The extensive market research conducted confirms that MTS is the only contractor with the demonstrated capability, proprietary parts, and specialized labor necessary to properly calibrate and maintain the critical press/load frames and Triax system. Choosing an alternative vendor, none of whom were found to be capable of performing the work, would lead to mission degradation and schedule disruptions due to their inability to meet the required standards. As the incumbent, MTS possesses unique, in-depth experience with the equipment; a new contractor would face a significant learning curve, introducing a high risk of errors and further delays that the mission cannot accommodate.

IX. Actions to Overcome Barriers to Competition (RFO 6.104-1(a)(11)):

Market research confirms that MTS Systems Corporations is the only responsible source with the demonstrated capability to meet the government's requirements without unacceptable risk or delay. Consequently, there are no practical actions the Government can take to overcome these barriers and foster competition for this specific,



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immediate requirement. For any subsequent actions, AFRL/RWTE will continuously monitor and assess if market conditions have changed by looking for companies able to calibrate and maintain the presses, load frames, and Triax system to the required standards. If another company appears to have the capability to service the equipment, AFRL/RWTE will contact them.